

HUNTER FANG AND THE EMPEROR'S BANNER

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PREVIEW ONLY

FADE IN:

INT. UNDERGROUND VAULT -- MOSCOW -- NIGHT

Giant carved art sculptures. Wall-mounted art fragments, ambient ceiling lights, velvet rope barriers separating the walkways from these masterpieces.

Countless rows of artwork from all over the world--a Jesus Christ depiction, an Asian textile fabric, stone carvings.

GLASS BOXES surround precious egg-shaped necklaces and large jeweled rings.

Bejeweled cups, and a handcraft jue cup with a large curved drinking spout.

Sharp-edged fragments, spearpoints from shining blades--

--and a special glass box on an ornate pedestal. Inside, a trident tip shaped of a golden flame. Tied around it, a thick weave of black hair. The tip is several feet, the hair several feet even longer.

A HAND presses against the glass--that of a MIDDLE-AGED MAN. Shoulder-length hair slicked back. A bearded goatee a bit longer than his chin. A leathery face worn down with time. This is GENGHIS KHAN.

He stares longingly at the artifact inside. Nearby, ANOTHER MIDDLE-AGED MAN approaches. Prominent chin beard, barreled chest, and clearly jealous. This is QIN SHI HUANG.

QIN SHI HUANG

I wouldn't want a pedestal like that. It makes you an easy target.

GENGHIS KHAN

And who are you, exactly?

QIN SHI HUANG

I'm the same as you. And still a thousand years ahead of your time.

GENGHIS KHAN

I didn't mean disrespect. I want to understand what binds you.

Qin Shi Huang struts proudly down the hallway.

Genghis Khan follows. They end up in front of the fancy cup with the curved drinking spout.

QIN SHI HUANG

I've seen the stories. The history.
They call me a fool. "Qin Shi Huang
poisoned himself with the very
thing he thought would save him."
You know where those people are?

Genghis Khan shakes his head.

QIN SHI HUANG (CONT'D)

Neither do I. They've passed. While
we're still here.

Genghis Khan is amused. He bows to Qin Shi Huang, who then
bows back.

Then, they hear a door OPEN. Footsteps get closer. Several
suited men approach. All wearing gloves. One of them pushes a
large cart.

They walk right past, oblivious to the presence of these two
storied men. Only the objects that bind them. The suited men
gather in front of the Genghis Khan's box.

Two of them get on each side of the box. One stands in front.
They nod their heads three times in sync, then raise the box
together. Carefully rehearsed, they gently place the box onto
the cart. They put a dark cloth over it. Everyone nods to
each other.

As if rehearsed, they get into a single file line. The cart
pusher is located in the middle.

Genghis Khan and Qin Shi Huang linger.

QIN SHI HUANG (CONT'D)

What did I tell you?

Genghis Khan ponders.

GENGHIS KHAN (V.O.)

I had everything to conquer. Only,
I ran out of time. And now, many
years later, everything has already
been found. So when there's nothing
left to find...people begin to
take.

INT. AUCTION HOUSE -- BIDDING ROOM -- SAME TIME

A HAND takes an hor d'oeuvre plate of caviar and cracker held
by a SERVER. The hand belongs to ULRICH WATSON. A man in his
50s, cocky, not afraid to show off.

Seated at a mini table, he holds a paddle #399 up high with his other hand.

ULRICH

Forty million. Let's get this over with.

At the podium, an AUCTIONEER stands impeccably dressed. Beside them, atop a steel pedestal: LOT 562: a massive dark fossil of a T-REX SKULL. Its large fangs GLEAM under the gallery lights. It's placed center stage.